

OPSC6311

PART 1 SECTION 2

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Introduction:

Currently, budgeting apps are something that everyone with responsibilities must have. Budgeting apps helps with tracking and monitoring your income. In this document we will be showing the planning and design of a digital tool that will make help users take better care of their finances. Using a budgeting app means you can enjoy the following benefits financial awareness, convenience and financial overview (Equifax, 2026). Each budgeting app is slightly different, therefore in this document we will be introducing the app, a detailed list of the requirements of the app, the user interface design with its mock-ups that will have descriptions and a diagram of how users will navigate around the app and finally the project plan, with milestones and deadlines.

Overview:

Ecospend is the name chosen for our **Personal Budget Bracker App**.



Figure 1.1

Figure 1.1 above shows the logo and app icon design for **Ecospend**. The colour scheme chosen was earthy colours which are your shades of green, shades of brown, neutral colours etc. The meaning behind the name is “Eco” comes from economy/ecosystem, and “Spend” is related to the financial behaviour. Therefore, the name means by using this app you are not just saving but you are spending your money wisely.

Innovative Features:

Innovative features help an application or software to stand-out from the rest. These are Ecospend’s innovative features:

- The app allows you to have joint accounts with friends or family members, whether you share expenses or savings goals. This means that the selected people will have access such as setting new goals, depositing and withdrawing money. They can also start new investments for the joint accounts.

- The app offers a 7-day free trial for new users. After the 7-day trial is over then they must pay the monthly fee for the premium benefits that the app will offer. Users can cancel the premium version anytime with no cost.
- The app offers a section for investments; users will get a chance to scroll through all the investments available in the app.
- The landing page will present a summary of what the app is about, the benefits of the app and how the app works for new users to understand how they can navigate around the app.
- The app will have a tracking page, this allows users to track their financial activities such as expenses, how far they are with their savings goals and their investments.
- Lastly the app will offer activities or games that will make user-experience fun. These games will give users a chance to earn rewards in a fun way, improving their satisfaction.

Requirements:

Launcher pager: When a user opens the application, the launcher page is the first screen they'll see. The app's logo will be prominently displayed in the middle of the screen on this page, making a good first impression and aiding in brand recognition. It will instantly take the user to the registration and login page.

Landing page: The Landing page presents EcoSpend with a brief summary and the app's slogan to make a good first impression. It emphasizes the app's goal and aids users in appreciating its worth. Users can choose to create an account or login thanks to the page's obvious Register and Login buttons.

Register and login: A registration and login screen will appear when the user installs the application for the first time. The user will need to provide their name, last name, email address, and password throughout the registration process. The user will go to the login page after registering successfully. To access the application, the user must input their password and username, which is their email address. If the user already has an account they can click a link at the bottom of the page, and they'll be shown the login page.

7-day free trial page: After logging in, the user will be directed to a page where they will be offered a free trial that lasts for 7 days. Alternatively, the user can choose to subscribe to the premium plan and skip the trial. Regardless of the option selected, the user will be required to enter their card details. This will allow the application to automatically deduct the subscription fee from the card on the specified debit order date.

Dashboard: The dashboard page will have a straightforward, easy-to-use design with buttons or alternatives that are easy to see. Important elements of the app, such as managing spending categories, entering expenses, attaching receipts, and setting budget objectives, will be accessible through these settings. The dashboard serves as the primary navigation screen, making it simple for users to navigate between the application's various areas.

Create Categories/Envelopes: The user will be able to create a new category/envelope for new expenses they would like to record. This enhances improved tracking of the user's expenses according to each category.

Investment page: The user will be able to easily and systematically manage and keep an eye on their investments thanks to the investment page. The user can enter information about their investments on this page, including the type of investment, the amount invested, and the date. Additionally, a summary of the user's investments will be shown on the page, enabling them to monitor their progress and comprehend how their money is increasing over time.

Tracking page: The tracking page will enable the user to keep an eye on their spending habits and financial activity. The user will be able to see how much they have spent, how their expenses are allocated among various categories, and how their spending stacks up against their budgetary objectives thanks to the summary and visual data displayed on this page.

Expenditure viewing page: The user will be able to add an expense by choosing a category, adding a photo of the receipt, and inputting the amount, date, and description. Additionally, the user will be able to set spending caps for categories and a monthly budget objective. The application will also give the user access to stored receipt photographs, a summary of all expenses for a chosen period, and the total amount spent in each category.

Mockup and Flow Diagram:

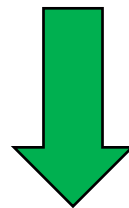
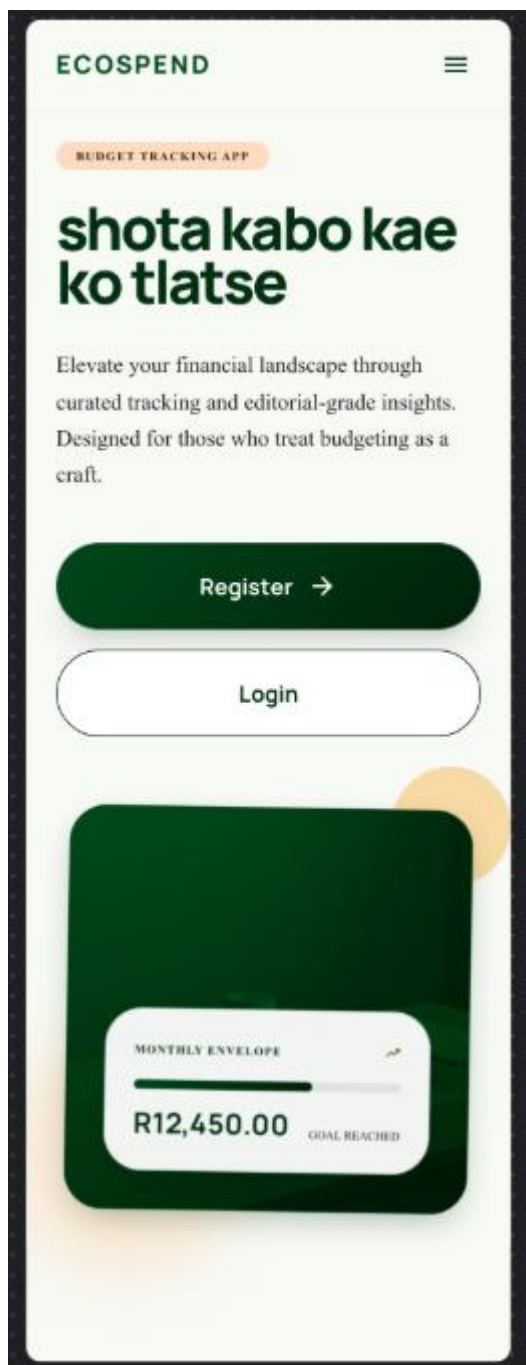


Figure 2.1 The Landing Page

The purpose of the Ecospend landing page is to provide a snippet of the app before the user logs in or registers. It shows what saving on Ecospend looks like. There is an envelope under the register and login buttons that shows the user that they can be close to reaching their saving goals using Ecospend. It increases the conversion rates by removing navigation links and focuses solely on the “Register” or “Login” message, Ecospend streamlines the user journey, increasing the likelihood of a new user registering (leadpages.com, 2024).

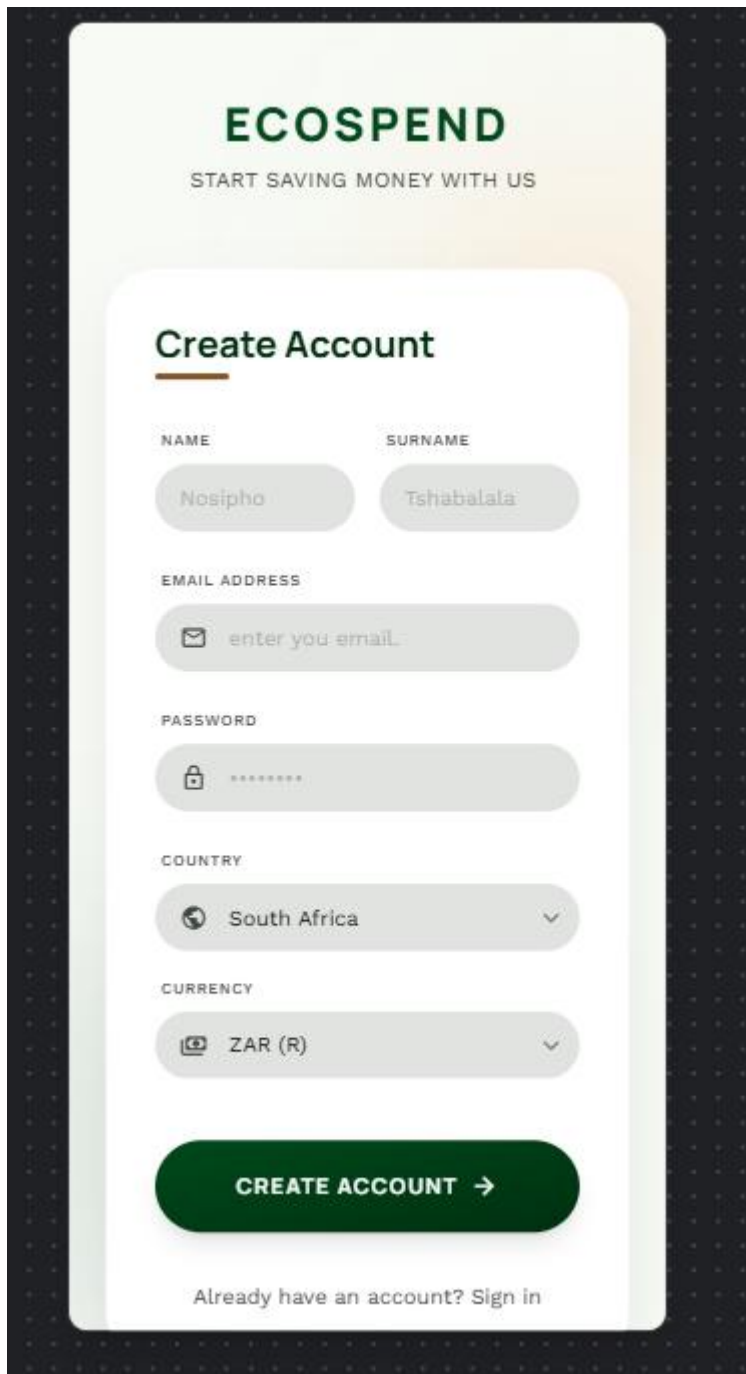
The image shows a mobile app interface for 'ECOSPEND'. At the top, the logo 'ECOSPEND' is in green, with the tagline 'START SAVING MONEY WITH US' below it. The main section is titled 'Create Account' with a green underline. Below this, there are several input fields: 'NAME' with the value 'Nosipho', 'SURNAME' with 'Tshabalala', 'EMAIL ADDRESS' with a placeholder 'enter your email', 'PASSWORD' with a masked input '*****', 'COUNTRY' with a dropdown menu showing 'South Africa', and 'CURRENCY' with a dropdown menu showing 'ZAR (R)'. At the bottom of the form is a large green button labeled 'CREATE ACCOUNT →'. Below the button, there is a link that says 'Already have an account? Sign in'. The entire form is set against a dark background with a subtle pattern of small dots.

Figure 2.2 Register Page

The purpose of the register page is to identify a new user and allow them to set unique credentials, like their username/email and password so that the user can access restricted content and personalized features. It will collect crucial information such as name, surname, email address, country and currency to personalize the user's experience and tailor content to their needs (SurveyMonkey.com, 2025).

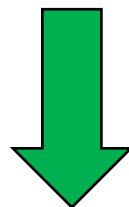
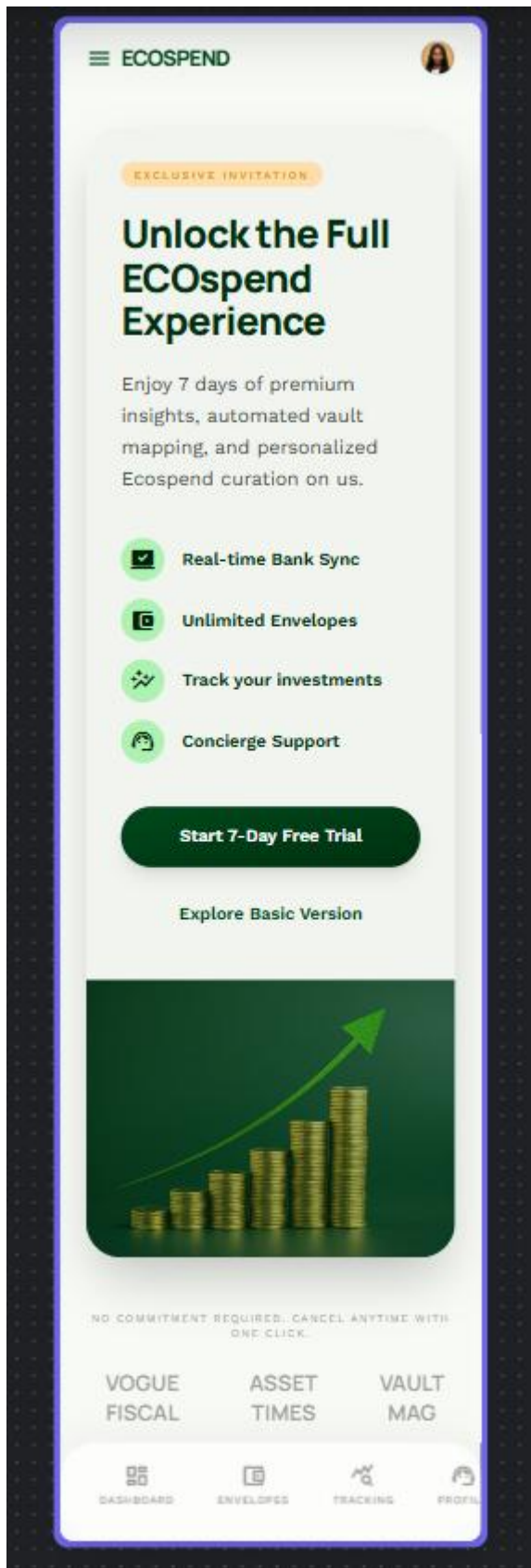


Figure 2.3 Pop up 7-Day Free Trial

The purpose of the Ecospend 7-day free trial ad is to serve as a little reminder for the user in case they want to upgrade to the premium version of Ecospend. It tells the user what the premium version of Ecospend offers.

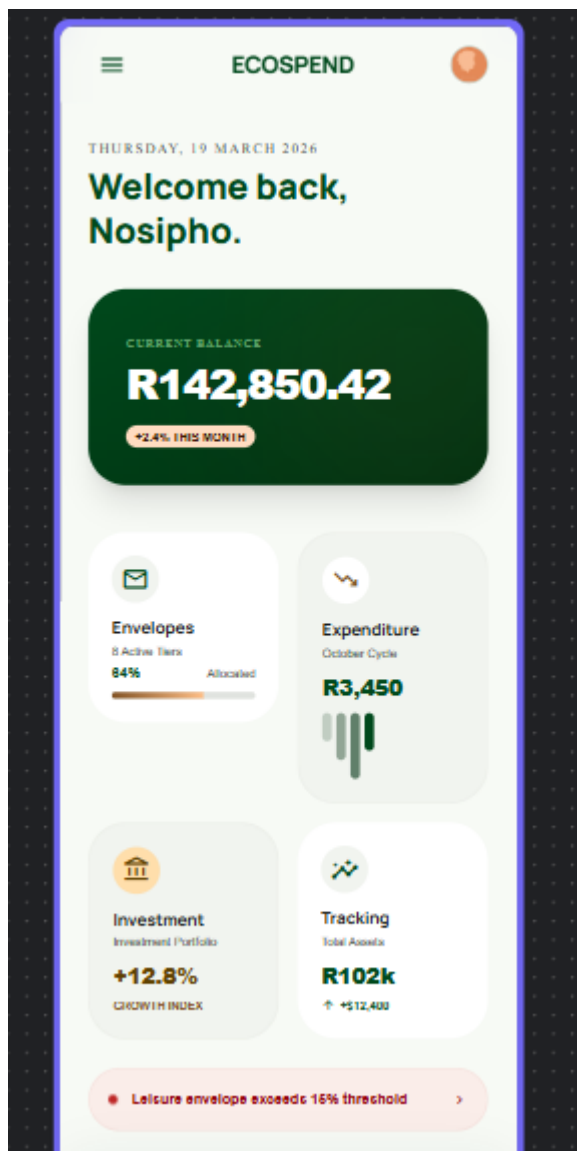


Figure 2.4 The Dashboard

The purpose of the dashboard is to enhance navigation. The dashboard acts as a central hub so that it's easier to access different parts of the application (Domo.com, 2025).

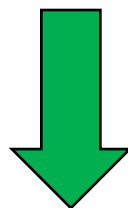
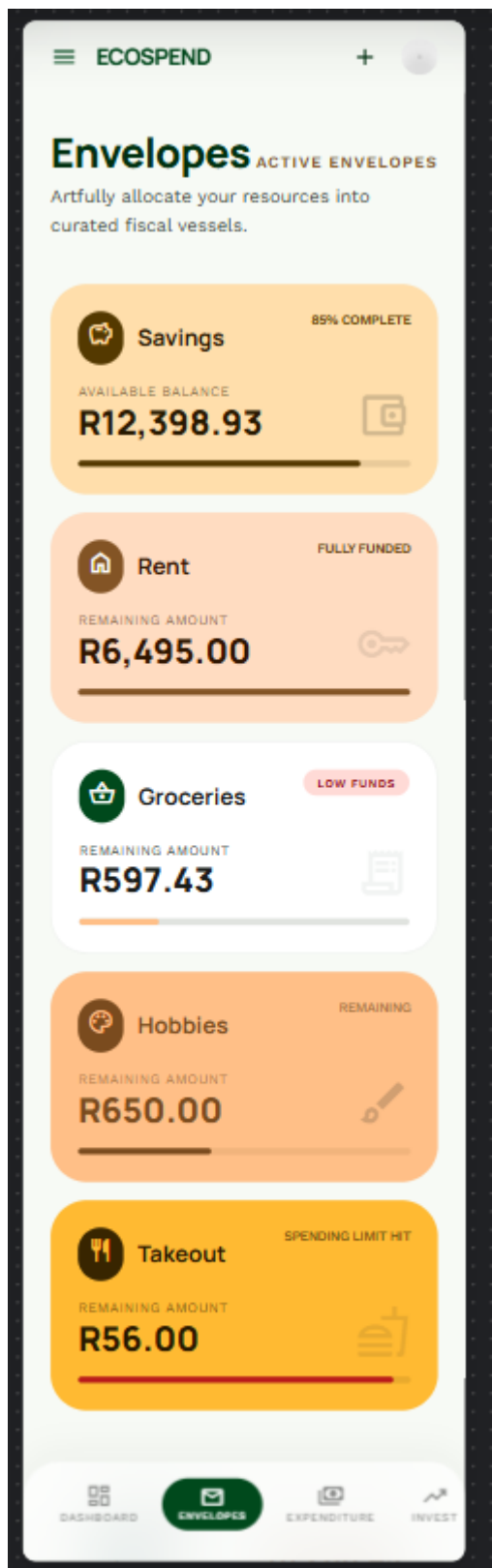


Figure 2.5 Envelopes Page

The purpose of the Envelopes Page is for the user to divide their expenses into categories, which will be called Envelopes. Here, the users allocate how much money they have budgeted for that specific category for their preferred time.

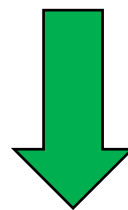
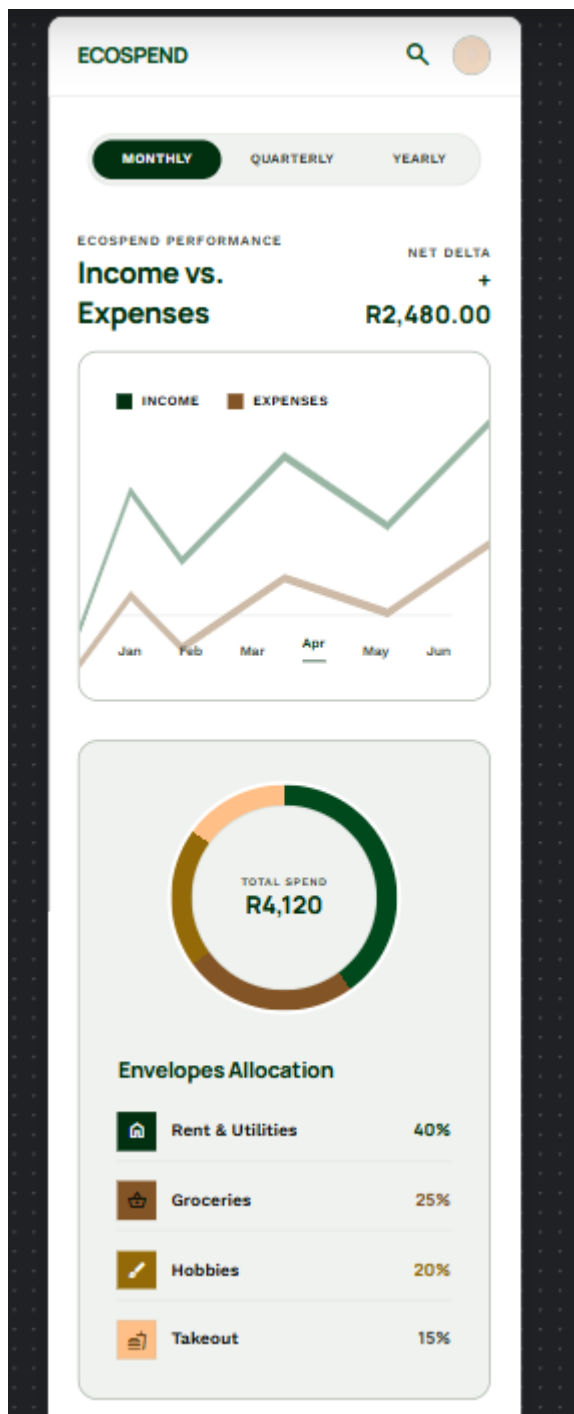


Figure 2.6 The Tracking Page

The purpose of the Tracking page is to report and show the user's spending habits. It will show what they spend the most on and the least on, in the form of a pie chart or a line graph. It will also show the total amount of money the user has spent monthly, quarterly and annually.

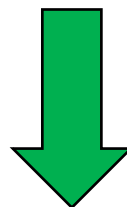
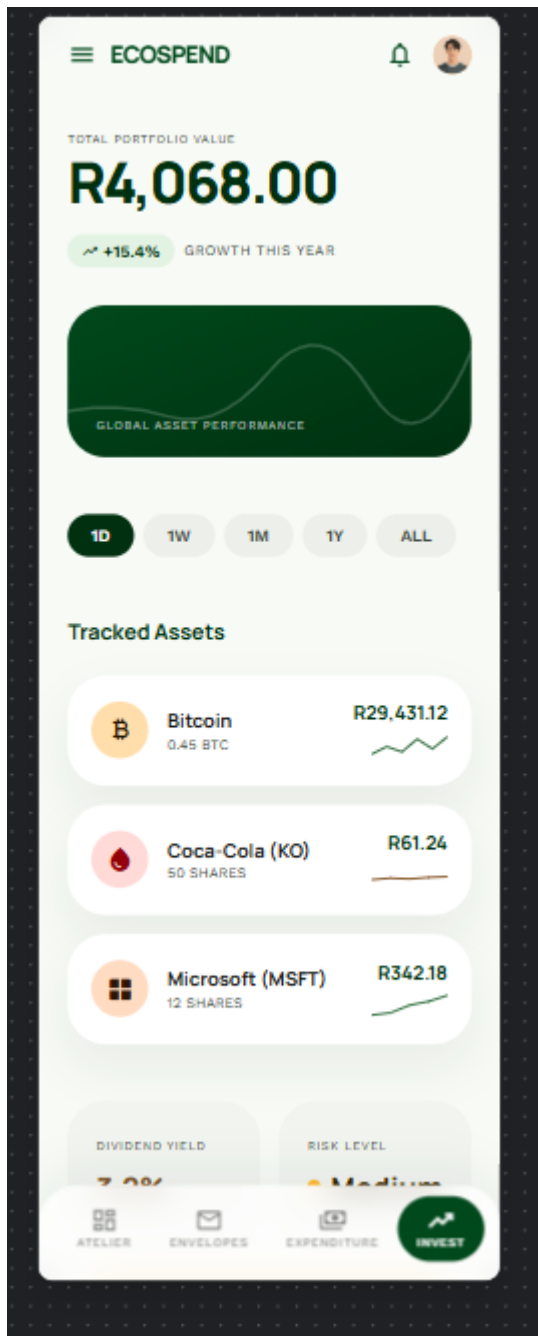


Figure 2.7 The Investment Page

The purpose of an investment page is to provide users with a convenient, integrated and secure platform to grow their money, manage their portfolios and access financial markets directly from their mobile devices. It serves to make investing accessible for everyone by giving access to both beginners and experienced users.

The user has their own portfolio so they can view detailed summaries, track investment growth, monitor interest earned and review transaction history in real time. The transaction history can be for the past day, week, month and even year (CapitecBank.co.za, 2022).

X

Expenditure

Scan Receipt

AI-powered ledger entry in seconds

AMOUNT SPENT

R 0.00

TRANSACTION DATE

2023/11/20

SELECT ENVELOPE CATEGORY

Rent

Groceries

Housing

DESCRIPTION & NOTES

What did you acquire today?

Add to Envelope

ENSURING ENVELOPE INTEGRITY

DASHBOARD

EXPENDITURE

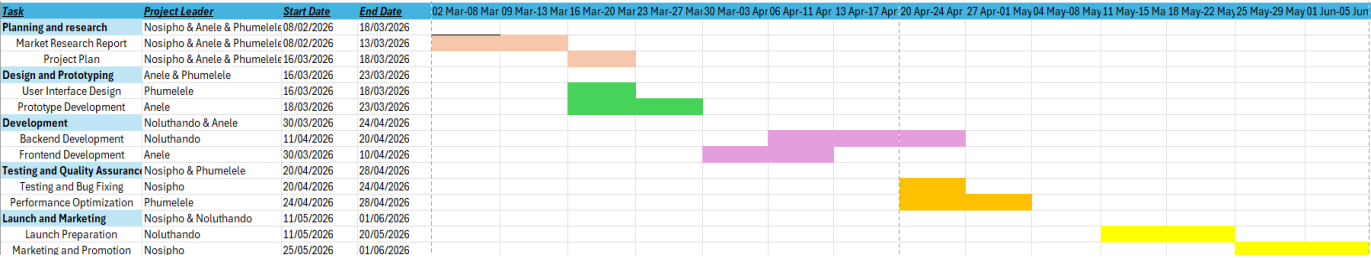
GROWTH

ENVIRONMENTS

Figure 2.8 The Expenditure Page

This page is for the user to manually insert their transactions and provide a receipt as proof of that transaction if necessary. Users insert the amount of money they spent and select which Envelope it goes into. They are also given the option to write a description/note about the purchase made.

Gantt Chart:



NB: The excel page has been linked as well

Conclusion:

In summary, EcoSpend allows users to manage their finances effectively through its user-friendly design, extensive features, and clear tracking tools. By offering a detailed view of spending behaviour and investment progress, EcoSpend helps individuals make knowledgeable choices and develop sound financial practices. Whether you're new to budgeting or have years of experience, EcoSpend is the ideal partner for reaching financial security and prosperity.

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[3/#:~:text=No%20investment%20experience?,from%20as%20little%20as%20R5.](https://www.capitecbank.co.za/blog/articles/best-way-to-bank/investing-really-is-as-simple-as-1-2-3/#:~:text=No%20investment%20experience?,from%20as%20little%20as%20R5.)

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